

Substitute Teacher Story Station Pack

A ready-to-use set of story station routines, quiet extension cards, and handoff notes for ages 7-11 in classrooms, homeschool co-ops, tutoring centers, and substitute folders.

\$39

Best for: Elementary teachers, homeschool co-op leaders, tutors, and substitute folders for ages 7-11.

Format: 12 printable substitute stations plus adult setup tools

No scary harm, no bullying, no romance, no weapons, no branded characters, no real child profiles.

Inside

One-page substitute guide for quick planning

Five low-prep story station routines

Eight early finisher cards for quiet writing choices

Six share prompts for gentle discussion

Simple setup notes for desks, tables, or floor spots

Printable-only directions with no digital tools required

Invented-world prompts for family-friendly storytelling

Flexible timing for short blocks or full rotations

Teacher handoff notes focused on completed materials

Calm routines that work without grading pressure

SUBSTITUTE SETUP

Run the substitute stations

Before the day

- Print one routine page for each station you plan to use.
- Print enough early finisher cards for quiet choice work.
- Place pencils, blank paper, and the selected station pages in one folder.
- Choose three to five stations based on the time available.
- Leave a simple note telling students that every story world is invented.

Morning setup

- Set station pages where students can reach them without extra explanation.
- Put blank paper beside each station page.
- Post or read the station order before students begin.
- Keep early finisher cards in a separate quiet-choice stack.
- Use a visible timer if the group already follows timed rotations.

During stations

- Read the first direction aloud, then let students work independently or with a partner.
- Remind students to write about invented characters and places only.
- Encourage short, complete ideas instead of perfect spelling.
- Rotate when the group is ready, or let students finish one station deeply.
- Use early finisher cards for students who complete a station before the group moves on.

End of day

- Ask students to place finished pages in the class work stack or take-home folder.
- Collect unused station pages so the teacher can reuse them.
- Circle any station that students especially enjoyed.
- Note whether the group completed all planned rotations or only part of the set.
- Leave early finisher cards in the substitute folder for future use.

Handoff

- Students completed printable story station work from invented-world prompts.
- No digital tools, personal details, or online sharing were used.
- The strongest participation appeared during the station choices marked on the pages.
- Unused pages and quiet-choice cards are returned to the folder.

World menu

AGES 7-9 Buttonwood Library Train	AGES 7-9 Pocket Park Notice Board	AGES 7-9 Penny Path Compass Shop	AGES 7-9 Acorn Avenue Errand Office	AGES 7-9 Rain Boot Route Rangers	AGES 8-10 Rain Gauge Railway
AGES 8-10 Seed Library Map Room	AGES 10-11 Index Card Theater Club	AGES 10-11 Margin Note Market	AGES 10-11 Clue Label Tower Museum	AGES 10-11 Revision River Ferry	AGES 10-11 Compass Craft Academy

Use these pages offline for adult-guided station work. Keep finished work in folders or send it home.

Station routines and optional share prompts

Map the Tiny Kingdom

Best for: A calm first station when students need a clear starting point

1. Draw a small invented kingdom with three places: a gate, a workshop, and a quiet garden.
2. Label each place with one detail that could start a story.
3. Choose one place and write what a friendly character notices there.
4. Add one kind problem the character can solve before leaving the kingdom.

Message from Moonberry Mail

Best for: Pairs or independent writers who enjoy letter-style prompts

1. Imagine a mail cart arrives from a town called Moonberry Hollow.
2. Write the first three sentences of the message inside the envelope.
3. Decide what helpful errand the message asks the reader to complete.
4. Write a short reply explaining the first step of the plan.

Three Object Story Tray

Best for: Students who benefit from concrete choices before drafting

1. Pick three invented objects: a glowing button, a silver seed, and a paper compass.
2. Choose which object a character finds first.
3. Write how the object changes the character's plan for the day.
4. End with the character using one object to help a neighbor in the story world.

Quiet Quest Countdown

Best for: Short blocks, tutoring sessions, or a final station before cleanup

1. Fold a page into four boxes and number them one through four.
2. In box one, sketch a peaceful invented place.
3. In boxes two and three, write two steps a character takes to complete a small quest.
4. In box four, write one sentence showing how the place is better at the end.

Story Helper Circle

Best for: Small groups that need a structured way to build one shared idea

1. Each student writes one invented setting on a scrap of paper.
2. Choose one setting and place it in the center of the group.
3. Each student adds one friendly helper, tool, or clue for that setting.
4. Independently write a short scene using the shared setting and one added idea.

Optional share prompts

Read one sentence that shows where your story takes place.

Share one invented object and explain why it matters.

Tell the group one kind choice your character made.

Name one detail you added after your first draft.

Share a title and explain which story clue it gives.

Tell one next scene you could write if you had more time.

Early finisher cards

5 MINUTES | SETTING DETAIL

New Door Detail

Add a door, archway, or path to your story world and write what makes it interesting.

7 MINUTES | REVISION

Better Ending

Write a second ending where the character solves the problem in a quieter or kinder way.

5 MINUTES | PLOT ADJUSTMENT

Tiny Problem Swap

Replace your story problem with a small mix-up, missing object, or confusing clue.

4 MINUTES | SEQUENCING

Quest List

List three steps your character could take next, then circle the step that would make the best scene.

5 MINUTES | CHARACTER SUPPORT

Helper's Pocket

Draw three safe objects a friendly helper carries, then write how one object is useful.

6 MINUTES | SENSORY LANGUAGE

Five-Sense Place

Choose one invented place from your page and add one sight, sound, smell, texture, and taste.

6 MINUTES | DIALOGUE

Friendly Dialogue

Write four lines of conversation between two invented characters who are making a plan.

3 MINUTES | MAIN IDEA

Title Test

Write three possible titles for your story and underline the one that gives the clearest clue.

Buttonwood Library Train Stop

Choose a library train stop, add three quiet details, and write the helper note.

Use this as calm independent writing; point to the first box and let children complete as much as fits the time.



Buttonwood Library Train

Ages 7-9

4 minutes setup

Substitute-day printable writing station for a quiet desk start, center rotation, or folder activity using one printed page.

Train Stop

The Buttonwood train stops beside _____.

The quiet platform has _____.

The ticket marker points toward _____.

Library Car

Inside the reading car, the shelf holds _____.

The soft seat looks like _____.

The train bell reminds everyone to _____.

Helper Note

First, the helper checks _____.

Next, the helper carries _____.

The note for the next rider says _____.

One Buttonwood detail I added well is _____.

Pocket Park Notice Board

Invent three tiny park notices, pick the clearest one, and write what the helper does next.

Partners may trade one idea aloud, then each child writes on a separate printed page.

Ages 7-9

5 minutes setup

Substitute-day printable writing station for a partner table, early finisher bin, or quiet center with simple invented notices.



Pocket Park Notice Board

Tiny Notices

The first notice asks for _____.

The second notice points toward _____.

The third notice reminds everyone about _____.

Park Details

The bottle-cap bench sits near _____.

The pebble path curves around _____.

The shade leaf covers _____.

Helper Choice

First, the helper reads _____.

Next, the helper adds _____.

The clearest park message says _____.

My best Pocket Park notice is _____.

Penny Path Compass Shop

Pick a compass clue, draw a penny path, and write three clear shop directions.

A quick sample direction on the board is enough; the page can be finished without extra explanation.

Ages 7-9

4 minutes setup

Substitute-day printable writing station for a direction-writing center using a simple compass clue and a short route note.



Penny Path Compass Shop

Compass Clue

The compass needle points toward _____.

The penny path begins beside _____.

The shop window shows _____.

Path Marks

The first path mark looks like _____.

The second path mark waits near _____.

The final path mark leads to _____.

Shop Directions

First, walk past _____.

Next, check the compass for _____.

The direction card ends with _____.

The clearest direction I wrote is _____.

Acorn Avenue Errand Office

Sort three errand slips, choose a helpful order, and write the office note.

Have the group choose invented places only; each child keeps their own page and can work quietly after setup.



Acorn Avenue Errand Office

Ages 7-9

5 minutes setup

Substitute-day printable writing station for a small group or desk activity where children sort friendly errand slips into a short story.

Errand Slips

The first leaf slip needs _____.

The second leaf slip belongs at _____.

The third leaf slip is marked with _____.

Office Sort

The acorn drawer holds _____.

The route list starts with _____.

The helper chooses this order because _____.

Office Note

First, the helper carries _____.

Next, the helper checks _____.

The finished office note says _____.

The errand order that makes sense is _____.

Rain Boot Route Rangers

Choose a rain boot route, add puddle-safe clues, and write a ranger message.

Keep this as dry paper planning; no water or outdoor movement is needed.

Ages 7-9

3 minutes setup

Substitute-day printable writing station for early finishers who can plan a cheerful rainy route with dry, tidy classroom supplies.



Rain Boot Route Rangers

Route Start

The rain boot route begins beside _____.

The first dry stepping spot is _____.

The ranger map shows _____.

Puddle Clues

The tiny puddle reflects _____.

The boot print curves around _____.

The safe path marker looks like _____.

Ranger Message

First, the ranger checks _____.

Next, the ranger points toward _____.

The route message says _____.

A careful route clue I wrote is _____.

Rain Gauge Railway

Read the rain gauge clue, plan the railway stops, and write a neat weather log.

This page works best after a brief reminder to use invented measurements and fictional railway details.

Ages 8-10

6 minutes setup

Substitute-day printable writing station for older elementary writers to combine observation words, sequence, and a short railway log.



Rain Gauge Railway

Gauge Clue

The rain gauge shows _____.

The railway platform waits near _____.

The first observation word is _____.

Railway Stops

Stop one is beside _____.

Stop two has a signal shaped like _____.

Stop three needs a note about _____.

Weather Log

First, the railway helper records _____.

Next, the helper compares _____.

The finished weather log says _____.

One observation that improved my railway log is _____.

Seed Library Map Room

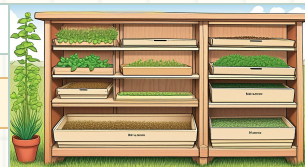
Choose a seed drawer, map a tiny route, and write the first note for the map room helper.

Use this station when students can work quietly from a printed page; invented plant names are enough.

Ages 8-10

5 minutes setup

Substitute-day printable writing station for a calm independent desk, co-op table, or tutoring rotation using a seed-map story plan.



Seed Library Map Room

Seed Drawer

The seed drawer label says _____.

The tiny seed packet holds _____.

The map room shelf is marked with _____.

Map Route

The first map turn goes past _____.

The second map clue is hidden near _____.

The final map mark points toward _____.

Helper Note

First, the helper plants the idea of _____.

Next, the helper checks _____.

The map room note says _____.

One map-room detail I want to keep is _____.

Index Card Theater Club

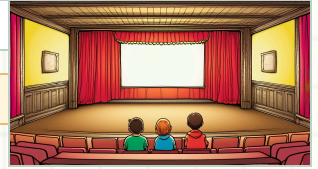
Pick a theater card, choose a scene job, and write a short exchange that moves the story forward.

Partners may read ideas quietly, but each writer should complete a separate page.

Ages 10-11

6 minutes setup

Substitute-day printable writing station for older elementary writers to plan a tiny scene with index-card roles and a short dialogue beat.



Index Card Theater Club

Scene Card

The theater card names a place called _____.

The card asks one character to carry _____.

The scene job for this card is _____.

Dialogue Beat

The first speaker says _____.

The second speaker answers _____.

The dialogue changes the plan by _____.

Stage Direction

At the start, the character stands near _____.

In the middle, the character notices _____.

At the end, the scene points toward _____.

The line that best moves my scene is _____.

Margin Note Market

Visit the margin note stalls, trade a weak detail for a stronger one, and write the revised sentence.

Use this as a no-pressure revision page; one improved sentence is a complete station outcome.

Ages 10-11

5 minutes setup

Substitute-day printable writing station for revision practice, early finishers, or a quiet table where students trade stronger details.



Margin Note Market

Market Stall

The first margin stall offers _____.

The second margin stall trades for _____.

The note seller recommends _____.

Detail Trade

A plain detail on my page is _____.

A stronger detail I can trade in is _____.

The sentence changes because _____.

Revised Line

Before revision, the sentence was about _____.

After revision, the sentence includes _____.

The improved sentence is _____.

One revision choice that helped my writing is _____.

Clue Label Tower Museum

Create three exhibit labels, choose the clearest clue, and write the tower museum note.

This station rewards precise words; students can finish with labels instead of a long draft.

Ages 10-11

6 minutes setup

Substitute-day printable writing station for a museum-label style activity that builds precise nouns, clues, and a short exhibit note.



Clue Label Tower Museum

Exhibit Labels

The first exhibit is labeled _____.

The second exhibit is labeled _____.

The third exhibit is labeled _____.

Clue Choice

The clearest clue is hidden beside _____.

The clue matters because _____.

The tower guide notices _____.

Museum Note

First, the guide checks _____.

Next, the guide adds a label for _____.

The exhibit note explains _____.

The most precise exhibit word I chose is _____.

Revision River Ferry

Load one sentence onto the ferry, cross the revision river, and unload a clearer version.

A student may revise a sentence from this page or invent a new rough sentence to polish.

Ages 10-11

5 minutes setup

Substitute-day printable writing station for a calm revision ferry route where students move one draft idea from rough to clearer.



Revision River Ferry

Ferry Load

The rough sentence starts with _____.

The ferry carries one detail about _____.

The sentence needs clearer words for _____.

River Crossing

At the first dock, I add _____.

At the second dock, I remove _____.

At the third dock, I choose the stronger word _____.

Clearer Unload

The revised sentence now shows _____.

The detail that changed most is _____.

My clearer version is _____.

One word I improved on the ferry is _____.

Compass Craft Academy

Choose a compass craft, list the materials, and write the first three steps of the academy plan.

Small groups may brainstorm materials together, then each writer completes a separate plan.

Ages 10-11

6 minutes setup

Substitute-day printable writing station for a self-directed craft-academy plan using directions, materials, and a short procedure-style scene.



Compass Craft Academy

Craft Choice

The academy craft is called _____.

The compass points toward _____.

The craft helps the story character by _____.

Material List

The first invented material is _____.

The second invented material is _____.

The safest classroom substitute for drawing it is _____.

Academy Plan

Step one of the craft plan is _____.

Step two of the craft plan is _____.

Step three of the craft plan is _____.

The clearest academy step I wrote is _____.